

Cross-functional	Any team member should be able to do what's required for the progress of the project. Also, when each team member can perform every job, it increases understanding and bonding between them.	In DevOps, development teams and operational teams are separate. So, communication is quite complex.
Communication	Scrum is the most common method of implementing agile software development. Daily Scrum meetings are carried out.	DevOps communications involve specs and design documents. It's essential for the operational team to fully understand the software release and its hardware/network implications for adequately running the deployment process.
Documentation	The agile method gives priority to the working system over complete documentation. It is ideal when you're flexible and responsive. However, it can hurt when you're trying to turn things over to another team for deployment.	In DevOps, process documentation is foremost because the software is sent to the operational team for deployment. Automation minimises the impact of insufficient documentation. However, in the development of complex software, it's difficult to transfer all the knowledge required.
Automation	Agile doesn't emphasise on automation. Though it helps.	Automation is the primary goal of DevOps. It works on the principle of maximising efficiency when deploying software.
Goal	It addresses the gap between customer needs, and the development and testing teams.	It addresses the gap between development + testing and operations.
Focus	It focuses on functional and non-functional readiness.	It focuses more on operational and business readiness.
Importance	Developing software is inherent to agile.	Developing, testing and implementation -- all are equally important.
Speed vs risk	Teams using agile support rapid change, and a robust application structure.	In the DevOps method, the teams must make sure that the changes that are made to the architecture never develop a risk to the entire project.
Quality	Agile produces better application suites with the desired requirements. It can easily adapt according to the changes made on time, during the project's life.	DevOps, along with automation and early bug removal, contributes to creating better quality software. Developers need to follow coding and architectural best practices to maintain quality standards.
Tools used	JIRA, Bugzilla and Kanboard are some popular agile tools.	Puppet, Chef, TeamCity, OpenStack and AWS are popular DevOps tools.
Challenges	The agile method needs teams to be more productive, which is difficult to manage every time.	The DevOps process needs the development, testing and production environments to streamline work.
Advantage	Agile offers a shorter development cycle and improved defect detection.	DevOps supports agile's release cycle.

- The target area of DevOps is software development whereas the target area of agile is to deliver end-to-end business solutions quickly.

- DevOps focuses more on operational and business readiness, whereas agile focuses on functional and non-functional readiness. 

 By: Harsukhdeep Singh

The author has worked as a QA engineer for the last four years and is an open source enthusiast.